Unpack the Almost Machine

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 6, Episode 1

The garden was open, and neighbors wanted a story-making station they could share at different places. Inside an unused workshop, Nib unrolled a magnificent plan wider than the door. Lark measured the actual opening. Beside it she drew four requirements: portable, dry, readable, and usable together. The door would keep its present size.

“An unfinished masterpiece,” Nib proclaimed proudly. “One useful beginning,” Lark replied warmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **garden**

“In unpack and unlock, un changes the action,” Lark modeled clearly. “Pack puts things together for carrying; unpack reverses that. Lock secures something; unlock reverses that. Read the visible base, add un, and check the new whole meaning.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try unpack, unlock. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read unpack on the storage note,” Lark invited gently. “Which small existing press can we lay out for one useful design?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **I can unlock the box. We can unpack the press.**

“What do the helpers unpack?” Lark asked gently. “Which action happens to the box first?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib unlocked the correct storage latch. A small hand press and its needed frame parts came onto the supported bench. The enormous drawing remained a drawing. Lark kept the door measurement and four requirements beside the smaller model. Its feed tray faced the wall, giving the next revision a clear purpose.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write unpack beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your first workshop journal page showed the real press, the unchanged door, and four visible jobs the finished station must do. Nib had found a useful beginning among many almost-finished ideas.